

HOUSE RESOLUTION 146

By Lamberth

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Paul Trowbridge Gillespie, Jr., of Memphis.

WHEREAS, the members of this legislative body were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Paul Trowbridge Gillespie, Jr., the father of our valued colleague Representative John Gillespie; and

WHEREAS, Paul Trowbridge Gillespie, Jr., was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born on June 6, 1947, in Morristown, New Jersey, Mr. Gillespie was the son of the late Paul Trowbridge Gillespie and Dorothy Anderson Gillespie; and

WHEREAS, Paul Gillespie moved to Memphis at a young age and attended Presbyterian Day School and then Memphis University School, where he excelled as a member of both the football and basketball teams; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Gillespie continued his athletic career and played for legendary Memphis University School coaches Jake Rudolph and Jerry Peters; he earned a football scholarship to Vanderbilt University and played on the 1965 freshmen team before starting as a defensive back; and

WHEREAS, following his graduation from Vanderbilt, Paul Gillespie returned to Memphis and began his career at First Tennessee Investment Management, while concurrently serving as a member of the Army National Guard; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Gillespie cofounded Southeastern Asset Management in 1975; in 1985, he went on to cofound NewSouth Capital Management, where he fostered connections with colleagues and clients alike for forty years; and

WHEREAS, a highly respected member of his community, Mr. Gillespie served as chairman for a number of boards, including Memphis University School, ArtsMemphis, Baptist Memorial Health Care Corporation Community Advisory Board, and the Trezevant Manor Foundation; additionally, he was president of the Liberty Bowl in 1986 and served on the selection committee for a number of years; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Gillespie was also deeply devoted to his family, and he always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, Paul Gillespie will be sadly missed yet fondly remembered by his beloved wife of forty-seven years, Elizabeth Johnston Gillespie; his sons, Paul Trowbridge (Paige) Gillespie III, Stuart Johnston (Alexis) Gillespie, and John Marston Gillespie (fiancée Mackenzie); his grandchildren, Bailey Elizabeth Gillespie, Paul Trowbridge Gillespie IV, and Grace Hastings Gillespie; his sister, Grace "Gaye" Gillespie (Haywood) Henderson; and nine nieces and nephews, whom he loved dearly; and

WHEREAS, Paul Gillespie was a lifelong member of St. John's Episcopal Church, which he served as senior warden on the vestry, helped lead the campaign to build the Parish Life Center, and contributed to numerous stewardship efforts; and

WHEREAS, the epitome of diligence and joy, Mr. Gillespie was proud to live a life of service and always endeavored to leave a positive impact on the community he so ably served and cherished for nearly eighty years; and

WHEREAS, Paul Gillespie leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this legislative body should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor the memory of Paul Trowbridge Gillespie, Jr., reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Gillespie.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.